



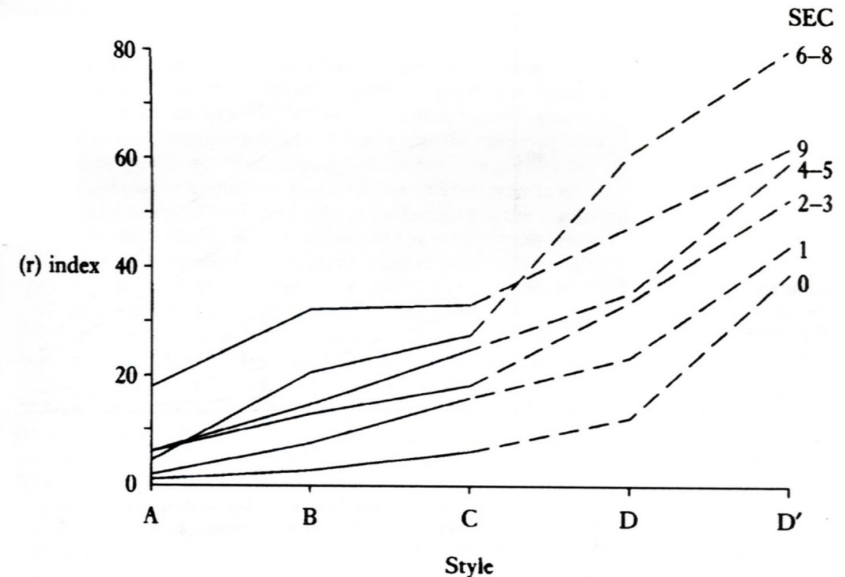
example case studies of sociolinguistic variables

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Labov (1972): [r] in careful vs. casual speech

- linguistic variable: [r] vs. [Ø] in speech
- contrasting different socioeconomic classes (SEC): lower, working, lower middle, and upper middle classes
- contrasting different styles: casual speech, careful speech, reading style, word lists, minimal pairs



SEC scale: 0-1, lower class; 2-3, working class; 4-5, 6-8, lower middle class; 9, upper middle class. A, casual speech; B, careful speech; C, reading style; D, word lists; D', minimal pairs.

Bell (1984): audience design

- linguistic variable: intervocalic /t/ voicing, e.g. 'writer' with a [t] or flapped [r]
- contrasting different audiences:
YA national radio (prestigious) vs.
ZB local community radio station
- contrasting different speakers:
four newscasters reading news bulletins
on both of these radio stations

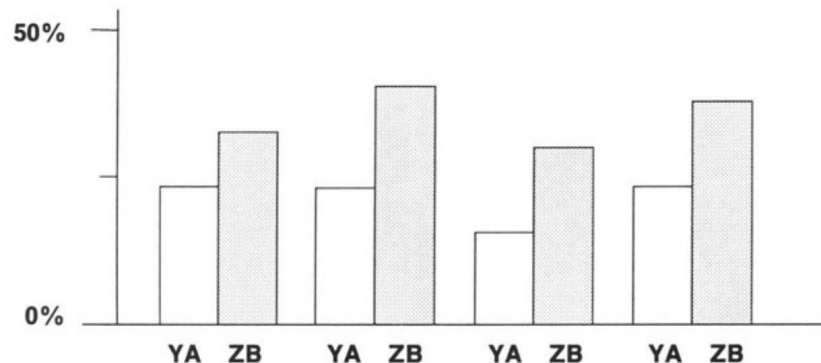


Figure 19.1: Percentage of intervocalic /t/ voicing by four newscasters on two New Zealand radio stations, YA and ZB (from Bell 1982: 162)

Bucholtz (1999): “nerd girl” speech

- linguistic variables on many levels
- contrasting different identities: negative vs. positive alignment with “nerd” practices

TABLE 1. *Linguistic identity practices of nerds at Bay City High School.*

Linguistic Level	Negative Identity Practices	Positive Identity Practices
Phonology	Lesser fronting of (uw) and (ow) ^a	
Phonology	Resistance to colloquial phonological processes such as vowel reduction, consonant-cluster simplification, and contraction	Employment of superstandard and hypercorrect phonological forms (e.g. spelling pronunciations)
Syntax	Avoidance of nonstandard syntactic forms	Adherence to standard and superstandard syntactic forms
Lexicon	Avoidance of current slang	Employment of lexical items associated with the formal register (e.g. Greco-Latinate forms)
Discourse		Orientation to language form (e.g. punning, parody, word coinage)

Callesano (2019): dialectal attributes in Spanish

- linguistic variable:
dialects of Spanish
- contrasting different ideas
of personal attributes:
warmth, competence,
attractiveness, likelihood
of learning English

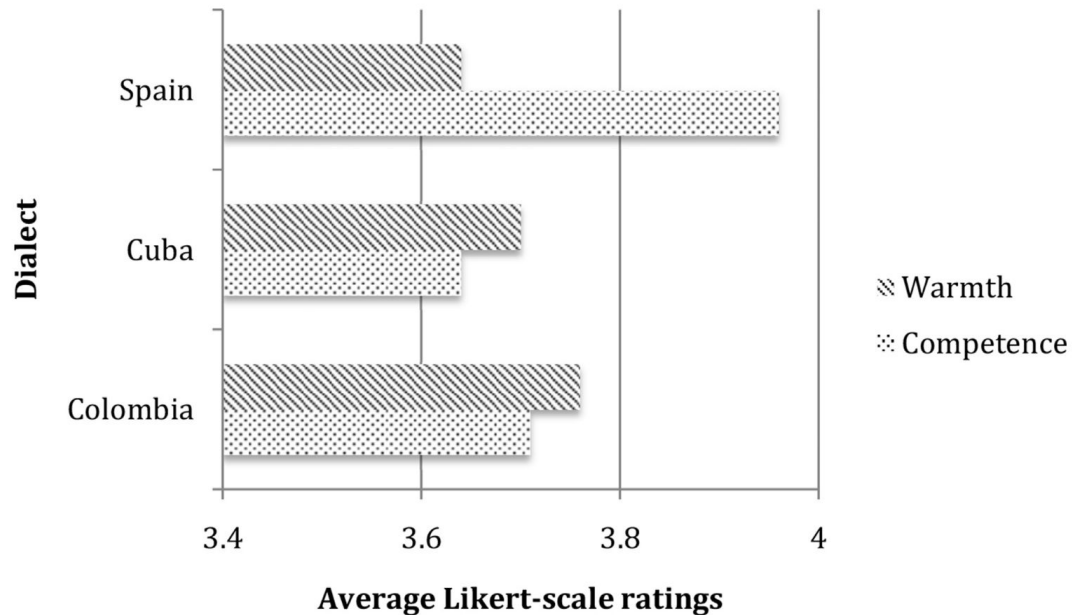


Fig. 1. Perceptions of warmth/competence by Latinx participants.

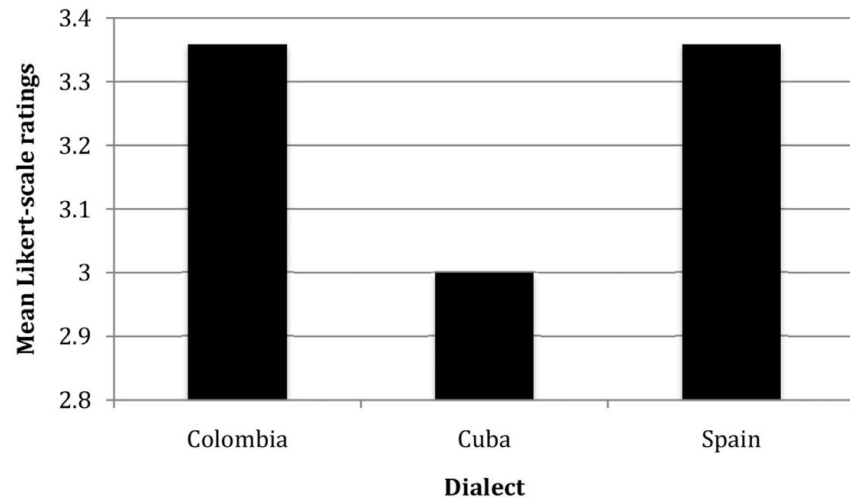


Fig. 2. Perceptions of physical attractiveness by Latinx participants.

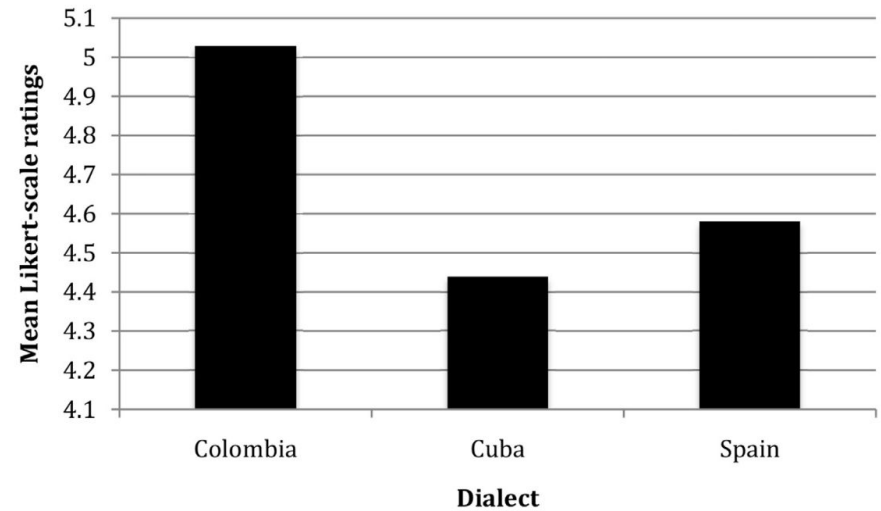


Fig. 3. Likelihood of learning English in the next year.

Eckert (1989): gendered participation in change

- linguistic variable: Australian Question Intonation (AQI), an emerging sound change
- contrasting different classes: lower working, upper working, and middle classes
- contrasting different genders: male and female

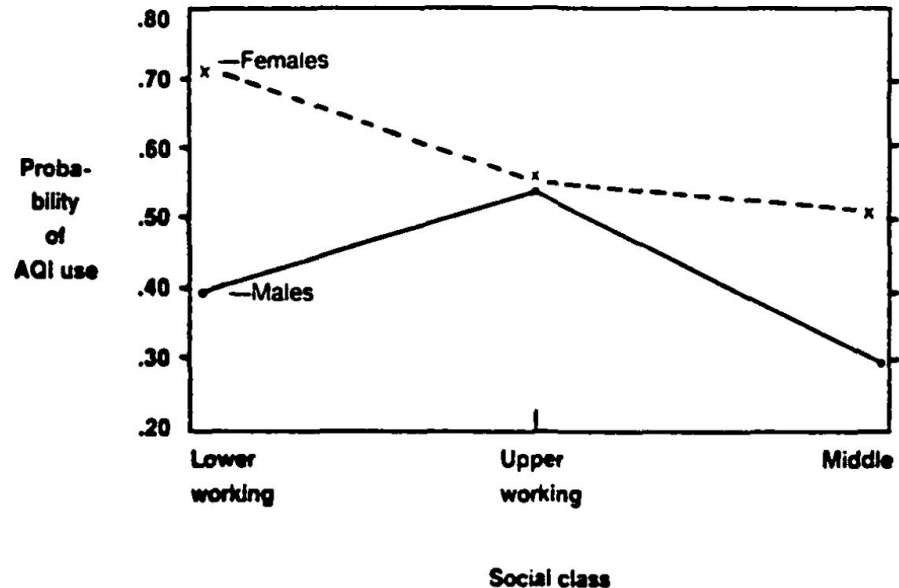


FIGURE 2. Probability of Australian Question Intonation use by class and sex (from Guy et al., 1986:37).



question: how might the use of
gender markers be different from
the use of class or ethnic markers?



Sharma (2018): Fareed Zakaria

- linguistic variable: use of American vs. Indian English
- contrasting different topics: countering doubt, building argument, quotation, parenthetical remarks

(5) Countering doubt (American audience)

21 Zakaria: but here's the problem. a Chinese businessman speaks English so he
can participate in our economy he can swim in our sea, as it were
22 but then he can penetrate the local Chinese market which is largely
Mandarin speaking

23 we can only swim in one sea you go to Brazil those guys can now
speak English and Portuguese

Rose: I don't know if that is true for the following reason most of the people
that I know from the private sector their world is global General Elec-
tric and all of those companies they generate more than fifty percent of
their revenues from business outside of the United States and they hire
and put in place a lot of local people who do speak the language

24 Zakaria: **and- and- and I say in the book the people who get this new world**
best

25 **are actually America's multinationals because they are living it=**

Rose: =that's right [and they li- and they learned it early=

26 Zakaria: **[and they l- and they =they**
learned it early because it was a question of survive adapt or
die=

Rose: =and opportunity=

27 Zakaria: =right now and I think you're absolut- GE by the way is a perfect
example of the transformation

28 and it's a metaphor I think I use it in the book for American foreign
policy

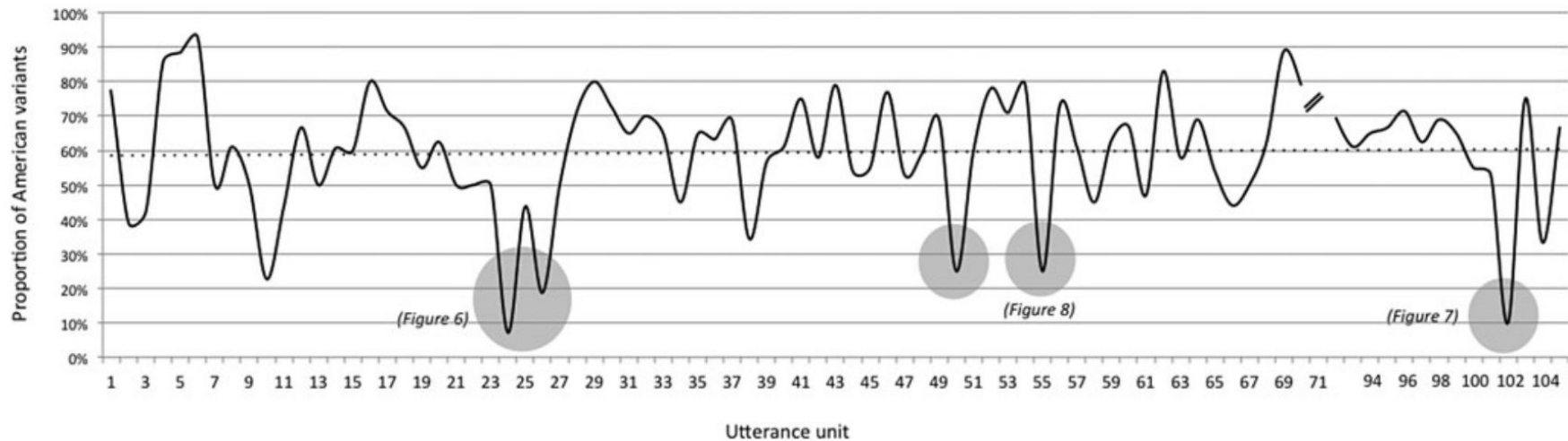


FIGURE 3. Full segment of Zakaria's speech during Charlie Rose interview.

Zimman (2017): phonetic behavior in trans men

- linguistic variable: fundamental frequency of speech, phonetic characteristics of /s/
- contrasting before and after transition (HRT)
- contrasting different speakers, age of transition, physiology, ethnicity

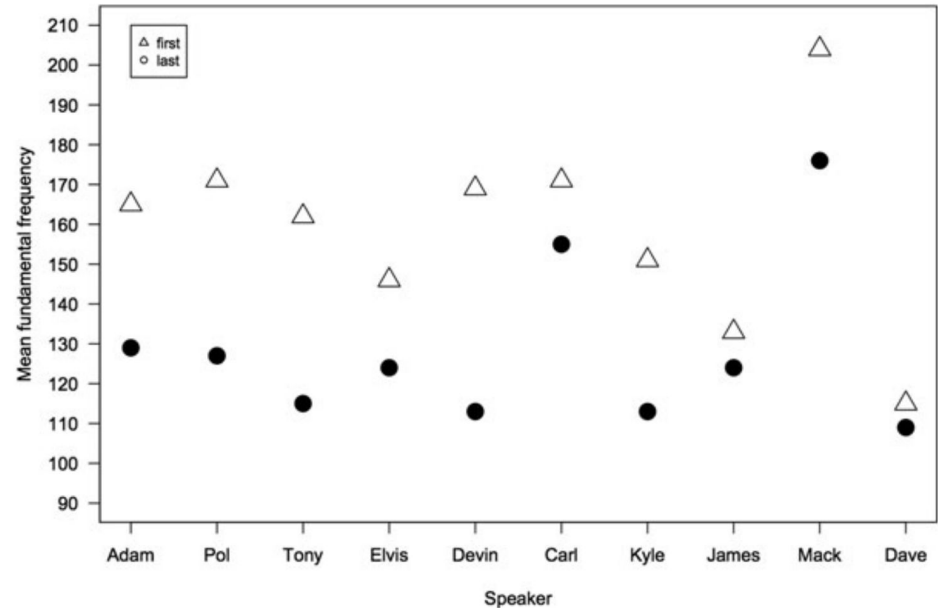


FIGURE 2. Mean F0 by speaker at first and last recording.

TABLE 5. *Changes over time in center of gravity for /s/.*

Speaker	First recording: COG & time on T	Final recording: COG & time on T	Difference	Regression coefficient	Regression <i>p</i> value
Adam	6,867 Hz (0 weeks)	6,481 Hz (55 weeks)	− 386 Hz	− 2.401	$p < 0.01^{**}$
Pol	7,983 Hz (0 weeks)	8,151 Hz (54 weeks)	168 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>
Tony	6,159 Hz (0 weeks)	5,734 Hz (54 weeks)	− 425 Hz	− 10.11	$p < 0.01^{**}$
Elvis	7,878 Hz (3 weeks)	8,174 Hz (71 weeks)	296 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>
Devin	9,459 Hz (8 weeks)	8,779 Hz (65 weeks)	− 680 Hz	− 9.803	$p < 0.001^{***}$
Carl	6,522 Hz (10 weeks)	6,877 Hz (73 weeks)	355 Hz	6.343	$p < 0.01^{**}$
Kyle	6,777 Hz (13 weeks)	6,616 Hz (72 weeks)	− 161 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>
James	7,907 Hz (25 weeks)	7,717 Hz (87 weeks)	− 190 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>
Mack	5,788 Hz (46 weeks)	5,933 Hz (138 weeks)	145 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>
Dave	9,014 Hz (65 weeks)	8,960 Hz (113 weeks)	− 54 Hz	<i>n.s.</i>	<i>n.s.</i>